



Mouthful of Ecstasy

A VORACIOUS BITE of Manam Chocolate's Roasted Almond Bark is the best way to savour rapture in Indian Cacao. Priced at ₹3,120, this isn't just a 21-inch-long chocolate slab but a manifestation of a chocolate revolution that has placed India firmly on the global Craft chocolate map. Founded by Hyderabad-based entrepreneur Chaitanya Muppala, Manam Chocolate is one of the finest single-estate chocolate makers in the country. It draws its strength from a state-of-the-art fermentation process, where the potential of beans from over 150 local farmers across 3,000 acres of West Godavari District in Andhra Pradesh is unlocked, revealing a distinct spectrum of flavour. At the heart of this constellation lies its signature: the Roasted Almond Bark. Hand-broken, irregular, and unapologetically elemental. Here, bold 60% dark chocolate mingles with creamy 45% milk and luxurious 40% white chocolate—all from West Godavari—studded with perfectly roasted almonds. A tasting of this trio unfolds like a symphony. Each chocolate's distinct character harmonises and greets the palate with deep, rounded cocoa notes—slightly fruity, faintly smokey—before yielding to the warm, buttery crackle of toasted almond. As it lingers, citrus hints of orange and grapefruit emerge wrapped in the sweetness of jaggery and leaving behind a finish that is long, complex, and quietly intoxicating. It is chocolate you don't simply eat, you remember.